

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

FRIDAY, MARCH 27, 2026

Years late, Keolis makes the T right

\$35,000 paid after queries tied to mishandled fares

By **Joey Flechas**
GLOBE STAFF

Six years after investigators discovered a troubling pattern of thousands of dollars in fare money going missing, the private company that operates the state's commuter rail system wired \$35,000 to the Massachusetts Bay Transportation Authority last August to cover the discrepancy.

The repayment is a tacit acknowledgment that two conductors improperly handled fares totaling tens of thousands of dollars.

The amount barely qualifies as a rounding error for Keolis Commuter Services: The state pays the firm nearly \$400 million a year to run the rail service under a long-term contract set to expire in June 2027. But the payout could take on larger significance as the T considers a Keolis-led consortium and two other bidders for the contract to run the commuter rail for the next decade or so.

The reimbursement was made only after the Globe began inquiring about missing money tied to a failure by two specific train conductors to

MBTA, Page A7

YVONNE ABRAHAM
COMMENTARY

Finding strength in each other to confront abuse

Think of the courage it took for Melissa Fares and Hilary Simon to get here.

It is two years, almost to the day, since Fares first spoke publicly about what Matthew Rutledge, her history teacher at Miss Hall's School, had allegedly done to her, starting in 2007, when she was a sophomore.

Two years since Fares reached out to Simon, who she suspected had also been abused by the charismatic teacher at the private girls' school in Pittsfield. Two years since Simon realized she had not been the only one: Rutledge had singled out each of them in exactly the same way when they were 14 and 15, ingratiating himself with their families, giving the girls pet names and extra attention that escalated to inappropriate talk, then physical contact, then sex, which continued long after graduation.

Two years since they started telling their stories together —

ABRAHAM, Page A6

All good cheer for Cup dry run



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

The crowd cheered as France took the field Thursday before its game against Brazil. More than 66,000 people were at Gillette Stadium.

Passion's not quite at full intensity yet, but fans still flock to Gillette for exhibition game

By **Chris Serres**
and **Camilo Fonseca**

GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — Brazilians call soccer o jogo bonito — “the beautiful game,” and on a crowded train to a World Cup exhibition match at Gillette Stadium Thursday afternoon, the phrase rang true. Voices rose in Portuguese and French, children bent over card games, and the echoes of past matches drifted across smartphone screens.

The buoyant mood spilled onto the platform at Gillette Station. Draped in the national colors of Brazil and France, thousands of fans moved in an easy current toward the stadium. Some broke off to kick soccer balls across the parking lot.

The logistics of getting tens of thou-



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Traffic on Route 1 was predictably slow.

sands of fans to and from Gillette — which for the seven World Cup games scheduled in June and July will be known as “Boston Stadium” — have been the subject of considerable angst in recent weeks. The local organizing committee has struggled to raise money amid a glut of other summer events, and the runup to Thursday's friendly was marred by a dustup over whether the town of Foxborough would get the money it had been promised for security.

Despite the lingering concerns, the exhibition game Thursday drew a huge audience — more than 66,000. And the security presence was equally robust, as organizers appeared intent on avoiding the kind of mayhem that sometimes erupts at international soccer matches.

WORLD CUP, Page A7

‘Federal law trumps state law.’

ANDREW ARTHUR, *a former immigration judge*

ICE arrests at courthouses on the rise

Lawmakers propose ban but state power in question

By **Sean Cotter**

GLOBE STAFF

CHELSEA — The pair of immigration agents sat quietly in the back of the courtroom, watching the parade of arraignments on an otherwise mundane recent morning in Chelsea District Court.

Then, in the early afternoon, they stood up and walked briskly out. Their target: A man who had been in court that day, whom they had been tracking. Within a few minutes, they were behind the courthouse, loading him into a black SUV that had been idling in the parking lot. A handful of activists yelled in protest, filmed the agents and their vehicle on their cellphones, and

blew whistles. They ran after the SUV as it left the lot, turned right, and vanished down the street.

Another immigration-related arrest at a Massachusetts courthouse.

As the Trump administration continues its deportation push here, federal agents are increasingly targeting people at courthouses in immigrant communities from Chelsea to Lynn to New Bedford, according to a Globe review of court data.

The Massachusetts Trial Courts system reported 614 immigration arrests at or near courthouses in 2025, more than double the 282 in 2024. In the first two months of this year, according to the trial court, ICE has made another 112 arrests at courthouses.

The presence of immigration agents has

COURTS, Page A8

Inmate suicides raise concerns about units

Several spent time in solitary substitute

By **Laura Crimaldi**

GLOBE STAFF

Most of the six inmates in Massachusetts prisons who died by suicide last year had been in or just left segregated units the Department of Correction had created to replace the discredited practice of solitary confinement.

In a new report, an independent consultant retained to look into the suicides found that for prisoners, the segregated cells “may be the same as being placed in restrictive housing thus resulting in increased risk for suicide.”

The findings echo concerns

raised by a legal advocacy group in a 2024 lawsuit on behalf of hundreds of inmates alleging conditions closely mirror solitary confinement and worsen prisoners' mental health.

The corrections department now uses so-called Behavior Assessment Units as a replacement for solitary confinement after a federal investigation in 2020 found that prolonged stays there violated the rights of prisoners with mental illness.

Corrections officials insist inmates have more freedom in

CORRECTIONS, Page A8



CAROLYN KASTER/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A GREAT START AND FINISH FOR THE SOX

Everything went right in a 3-0 win over Cincinnati on Opening Day, with ace Garrett Crochet shutting the door through six innings and the bullpen doing the rest. Closer Aroldis Chapman picked up the save and celebrated with Carlos Narváez. Roman Anthony had a big day, leading the way with three hits. **C1.**

President Trump said he will sign an order instructing the Homeland Security secretary to immediately pay TSA agents as Congress struggled to reach a deal. **A2.**

A suspended Plymouth police officer and her husband were charged with child rape after being accused of sexually assaulting a boy. **B1.**

Boston-based DraftKings and New York-based FanDuel are accused in a lawsuit of

using AI to develop and distribute “highly addictive” wagering opportunities. **B5.**

The driver of a BPS bus that killed a child was involved in a hit-and-run crash just a few months later as he drove on a suspended license, prosecutors said. **B1.**

Country star Zach Bryan paid a record price for the 120-foot-long scroll of Jack Kerouac's “On the Road,” with plans to display it in Lowell. **G1.**

Jump up and down

Friday: Cooler, breezy. High 47-52. Low 25-30.

Saturday: Much colder. High 36-41. Low 26-31.

Sunrise: 6:35. Sunset: 7:04

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C11.

VOL. 309, NO. 86

*
Suggested retail price
\$4.00

